THINGS TO TRY IF YOU ARE WAKING UP IN THE MIDDLE OF THE NIGHT

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Here are some techniques successfully used in research studies-- to help people stay asleep longer -- and fall back asleep if they wake up too early.

1. "Instead of trying to get back to sleep - you're going to learn how to put yourself into a hypnotic trance - and who knows - this may lead to sleep - but - if it doesn't - you will still receive the same benefit as being asleep - because one hour of hypnosis is worth eight hours of quality sleep.

So - whenever your sleep is interrupted and it is time for you to go back to your bed . . . I would like you to make yourself as comfortable as you can possibly be - and begin by imagining that you are to be asked to perform a particularly unpleasant task. This should be something that you really don't want to do and would go out of your way to avoid.

Of course - if you were asleep - you wouldn't need to respond to the request - so - I want you to pretend that you really are asleep.

Pretend by mimicking the breathing pattern that you adapt when you're just dropping off into slumber . . .
And as you do - find your tired body beginning to relax - beginning to feel heavy - beginning to feel comfortable – and that heaviness spreads up through your body. . .
Now take yourself back to the top of that beautiful staircase . . . going down - deeper and deeper with each step down - relaxing - more and more - feeling heavier and more comfortable than you ever thought possible.

. . .and perhaps now you begin to see the door at the bottom of the stairs - allow the door to formulate in your inner vision . . .
when you open that door and walk through - closing it gently behind you - you will find yourself in a wonderful place - having closed the door on any distractions.

Each and every time you go through this door you will discover something different - as you explore the beautiful realms of your subconscious mind. . ." (hypnoticworld.com)

2. Focus on one of your happiest memories -- reliving it in your mind in great detail. (For example, swimming with dolphins in Jamaica).

3. Instead of keeping your eyes closed, try keeping them open and looking out into the darkness of the room. This may help with triggering natural melatonin production. After a while the eyes will likely feel tired and want to shut.

4. Remind yourself that you have slept well in the past -- even if sleep hasn't always been good lately.

5. Tell yourself "I refuse to worry about anything in life -- and I refuse to worry about whether I will fall asleep -- during my sleep state and during the time I have scheduled for sleep. I deserve my peaceful, restful sleep. I need sleep to respect and protect my body. I need my body to live. My body needs sleep to survive. I owe my body respect and protection."

6. Visualization of a soft, black velvet curtain which has a warm, comfortable feeling about it. As thoughts enter their minds, allow these to drift across the curtain and disappear out of the other side of the mind.

Visualization of a scene in which subjects imagine themselves on the veranda or patio of a lovely house which has 10 steps leading down to a beautiful garden below. For each step, they allow themselves to let go more and more. At the bottom of the steps, peaceful and relaxed, they enter the garden, attention being drawn to the colors, flowers, drifting clouds, sound of bird singing, rustle of leaves in the trees, and the pleasant warmth of the sun.

-Letting go of problems. The garden visualization continues with patients picturing themselves lying on the grass, enjoying the warmth of the sun on their faces. Lying there, they are able to watch the leaves fall slowly from the trees nearby, these fallen leaves serving as a reminder of how it is possible to let go of old problems and worries, permitting them to drop away, just as old leaves drop away from the trees to make way for new rows and challenges.

-Special place. After letting go of problems, subjects are able to remain in the garden, or, if they prefer, "go away" to a special place where they are able to feel peaceful and content.

-Tell yourself: "It is not really lack of sleep which is the problem but worrying about lack of sleep. It is irrelevant whether I fall asleep or not because my mind and body will be repaired during their relaxation period to the same extent as if I was actually asleep. I need worry no longer about the possible negative effects of lying awake for I can spend this time in the practice of the above visualizations. As I do that, I will probably find that I drift into sleep."

7. Tell yourself: "I will sleep deeper --- and go deeper like a fish swimming deeper deeper into the water."